

Unit 05: Student-Centered Methods

5.1 Learner Engaged Learning Category

5.1.1 Concept

Learner engaged learning focuses on **active involvement of students** in the learning process. Students think, discuss, analyze, and reflect individually.

5.1.2 Strategies and Their Use

1. Brainstorming

- Students generate ideas freely.
- Used for introducing new topics.

2. Think-Pair-Share

- Think individually → Discuss with partner → Share with class.
- Encourages participation.

3. Directed Reading Activity (DRA)

- Teacher guides reading with questions.
- Improves comprehension.

4. Prediction from Terms

- Students predict lesson content from key words.
- Activates prior knowledge.

5. Direct Listening Thinking Activity (DLTA)

- Teacher reads text; students predict and verify.
- Enhances listening skills.

6. Text Coding

- Students mark text with symbols (✓, ?, !).
- Improves understanding.

7. KWL (Know–Want to Know–Learned)

- Identifies prior knowledge and learning goals.

8. What? So What? Now What?

- Reflection strategy.
- Used after activities.

9. Verbalized Learning

- Students explain learning verbally.
- Enhances clarity.

10. Learning Stations

- Different activity corners in classroom.
- Promotes independent exploration.

5.2 Cooperative Learning Category

5.2.1 Concept

Cooperative learning involves **small groups working together** to achieve shared goals.

5.2.2 Strategies and Their Use

1. Paired Reading & Summarizing

- Two students read and summarize.
- Improves comprehension.

2. Reciprocal Teaching

- Students take turns as teacher.
- Develops leadership and understanding.

3. Read–Summarize–Question

- Read text → Summarize → Create questions.
- Promotes analysis.

4. Jigsaw

- Each group learns part of topic and teaches others.
- Encourages responsibility.

5. One Stay Others Stray

- One member explains; others visit groups.
- Promotes sharing.

6. Mix–Freeze–Pair

- Students move, stop, and pair to discuss.
- Energizing strategy.

7. Pens in the Middle

- Group discussion before writing.
- Encourages teamwork.

8. Pyramid Learning

- Individual → Pair → Group → Whole class.
- Builds confidence.

9. Paragraph Expert

- Each student becomes expert of one paragraph.
- Encourages mastery.

10. STAD (Student Teams-Achievement Division)

- Group learning + individual test.
- Promotes accountability.

5.3 Problem-Based Learning Category

5.3.1 Concept

Problem-Based Learning (PBL) focuses on solving real-life problems through investigation and reasoning.

5.3.2 Strategies and Their Use

1. IDEAL

- Identify problem
- Define problem
- Explore solutions
- Act on solution
- Look back (evaluate)

2. DUPE

- Define
- Understand
- Plan
- Evaluate

3. I-Search

- Students research a question of interest.
- Encourages independent inquiry.

4. Socratic Questioning

- Teacher asks probing questions.
- Develops critical thinking.

3. Sample Lesson Plan Using Student-Centered Strategies

Subject: Social Studies

Class: 8

Topic: Climate Change

Duration: 45 Minutes

Objectives

Students will:

- Explain causes of climate change.
- Suggest solutions.
- Work cooperatively.

Teaching Materials

- Chart papers
- Markers
- Textbook

Teaching Procedure

1. Introduction (Brainstorming – 5 min)

- Ask: “What do you know about climate change?”
- Write ideas on board.

2. Development (Jigsaw – 20 min)

- Divide class into groups.
- Each group studies one cause (deforestation, pollution, greenhouse gases).
- Groups teach others.

3. Problem-Based Activity (IDEAL – 10 min)

- Present problem: “How can our school reduce pollution?”

- Students identify and suggest solutions.

4. Reflection (What? So What? Now What? – 5 min)

- What did you learn?
- Why is it important?
- What will you do?

5. Evaluation (5 min)

- Short oral questions.
- Homework: Write 5 ways to reduce climate change.